Editing the Ty's Future Stars Foundation website

This is for LaSonya. You do not need to know anything technical to use it, and you cannot break the website by following it.

The short version: go to **tysfuturestars.org/admin**, sign in, change something, press **Save**. It is live in about a minute.

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1. Before your first login

This section is for Grey, not LaSonya. It happens once.

The editor saves changes into the website's code repository on GitHub, so LaSonya needs a GitHub account with permission to write to it.

a) She needs a free GitHub account

Send her to **github.com/signup**. It is free. She needs:

- an email address she can open right now (GitHub emails a code)

- a username — anything, it is never shown on the website
- a password

Tell her to save the password somewhere she will find it again. She will use this maybe twice a year, which is exactly long enough to forget it.

b) Add her to the repository

1 Go to **github.com/Grey1-sys/tys-future-stars-foundation**

2 **Settings** → **Collaborators** → **Add people**

3 Enter her GitHub username

4 Give her the **Write** role. Not Admin — Write is everything she needs and nothing she doesn't.

5 She gets an email invitation. **She must click the link and accept it.** Until she does, the editor will let her sign in and then show nothing.

c) Connect GitHub to Netlify, so the editor can sign her in

The editor uses Netlify to handle the GitHub login. One-time setup:

1 On GitHub: **Settings** (your personal settings, top-right avatar) → **Developer settings** → **OAuth Apps** → **New OAuth App**

- Application name: `TFSF Website Editor`
- Homepage URL: `https://tysfuturestars.org`
- Authorization callback URL: `https://api.netlify.com/auth/done`
- Register, then **Generate a new client secret**. Copy the **Client ID** and the **Client Secret** — the secret is shown once.

2 On Netlify: your site → **Site configuration** → **Access & security** → **OAuth** → **Install provider** → **GitHub**, and paste the Client ID and Client Secret.

That is it. There is no password to put in the website's code, and nothing secret is stored in the repository.

d) Check it yourself first

Open `https://tysfuturestars.org/admin`, sign in, change one word on a page, save, and watch it go live. Do this **before** handing the guide over, so her first attempt is not also the first test.

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2. How to log in

1 Open **tysfuturestars.org/admin** on your phone or computer.

2. Press **Sign In with GitHub**.
3. Enter your GitHub username and password if it asks.
4. You will land on a screen with a list down the side: Events, Updates, Success stories, Impact numbers, and so on.

Bookmark that page. On an iPhone: the share button, then *Add to Home Screen*. It will sit on your home screen like an app.

If it says you do not have access, check your email for the GitHub invitation from Grey and click the Accept link in it.

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3. The one rule

> **Saving publishes it.** There is no second "publish" button. When you press Save, the change goes to the live website, usually within a minute.

That is why almost everything has a switch at the top called **Show this on the website**. Leave it **off** while you are still writing. Turn it **on** when you are ready. You can save as many times as you like with it off — nobody sees anything until you turn it on.

You cannot break the website. The worst you can do is publish a typo, and you fix a typo the same way you made it.

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4. How to add an event

1. **Events** in the side list.
2. Press the **+** (or **Add**) to add a new one to the list.
3. Fill it in. The boxes that matter:

Box	What to put
Show this on the website	**Leave OFF until everything else is right**
Event name	What you'd call it on a flyer
Short name for this entry	Lowercase with dashes: `spring-classic-2026`
Date	Tap it and pick the day

Box	What to put
Time	However you'd say it: `10:00 AM – 4:00 PM`
Place name	`Smyrna Community Center`
Street address	The full address — this becomes a tappable Maps link
One-line summary	One sentence; this is what people see in the list
Full description	The longer version
Sign-up link	Paste the Eventbrite / Google Form link, or leave empty

4 Turn **Show this on the website** ON.

5 **Save.**

Check the address twice. It becomes a link that opens Maps, and a wrong address sends a family to the wrong parking lot on a Saturday morning.

No sign-up link yet? Leave it empty. The page then says registration details are coming, which is better than a button that goes nowhere. Come back and add the link later.

Events move themselves. Once the date has passed it drops out of "Coming up" and into "Recently" on its own. **You never have to delete an old event.**

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5. How to post an update

An update is a short news post. Three or four a year is plenty — it is the main reason Google finds anything new on the site.

1 **Updates** in the side list → **+**

2 Fill in:

- **Headline** — what happened
- **Web address name** — lowercase with dashes: `fall-season-recap`
- **Date**
- **Written by** — your name
- **One-line summary** — one or two sentences for the list
- **The update itself** — the actual post. Press Enter twice between paragraphs.
- **Photo** — optional, see below

3 Turn **Show this on the website** ON, then **Save**.

If you add a photo you must fill in "Describe this photo." Write what is in it, as if to someone on the phone who cannot see it: *"Players lined up along the baseline after a game, holding a trophy."* If you leave it blank the photo will not appear at all — that is deliberate, so that blind visitors are never shown a blank space with no explanation.

Once you have published an update, the web address name is in the link people share. Changing it later breaks their link, so get it right first time and then leave it alone.

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6. How to add a story

A story is about one of our young people, in their own words.

Read this part before anything else

Three switches control whether the story ever appears. The website checks them and will simply refuse to show a story that does not pass:

Switch	What it means
Has this person agreed to have their story published?	Only ON if you have actually asked them and they said yes
Is this person under 18?	Answer honestly
Do you have a SIGNED media release on file for them?	Only ON if a signed release is **physically in your files**

If the person is under 18, both the consent switch and the signed media release switch must be ON. A story about a child without a signed release on file will not appear on the website no matter what else you fill in, and no matter how many times you save it.

That is not a bug and it is not something to work around. It is the protection for that child and for the foundation. If you find yourself turning the release switch on so that a story will appear, stop and go and find the signed form first.

Then the rest

1. **Success stories** → **+**
2. Their name — a first name on its own is usually the kinder choice.
3. Headline, short version, the full story.
4. **A quote from them** — only words they actually said. Never write a quote on someone's behalf, even a flattering one.

5 Photo — only if the media release covers photographs. If you are not certain, leave it out. The story reads perfectly well without one.

6 Turn **Show this on the website** ON → **Save**.

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7. Impact numbers and the donation goal

The numbers on the Impact page

Impact numbers in the side list.

Each one has three separate boxes, and this trips everyone up at first:

Box	For "$7,000+" you put
Symbol before the number	`$`
The number itself	`7000` — digits only, no commas, no dollar sign
Symbol after the number	`+`

The number box must contain **only digits** or the counting animation will not work.

If you are not sure a number is right, delete it from the number box and save. The website then shows nothing at all for that figure, which is far better than showing a guess. A wrong number on a charity website is the one mistake that costs you a grant.

Two more boxes go with every number:

- **Where this number came from** — e.g. *"Counted from our 2026 scholarship files"*
- **Date you last checked it**

If you cannot fill in where it came from, the number is not ready to publish yet.

The donation goal bar

Same place — **Impact numbers** — in the entry called **campaign-goal**.

- **The number itself** = how much has been raised so far
- **Goal** = what you are aiming for

The bar needs both. If either is empty the whole bar is hidden, which is intentional: half a goal bar tells a donor nothing and invites them to assume the worst.

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8. How to add a sponsor logo

1. **Sponsors** → **+**
2. **Business name** — exactly how they spell it, punctuation and all.
3. **Their logo** — see the sizes below.
4. **Their website** — must start with `https://`
5. Turn **Show this sponsor** ON → **Save**.

What to ask the sponsor for

> "Could you send us your logo as a **PNG or SVG with a transparent background**, around **400 pixels wide**? We'll put it on our website's sponsor page."

Those are the words to copy into an email. If they send something else:

What they send	What to do
A PNG or SVG	Perfect. Upload it.
A big photo or JPEG	Upload it anyway — it gets resized automatically
A photo of a business card	**Don't.** Leave the logo box empty — their name shows as text, which looks far better than a blurry card
Nothing yet	Leave the logo empty and fill in the name

Every logo sits in a box of the same size, so a wide logo and a square one will both look right. You do not need to crop or resize anything.

Only add a sponsor once the partnership is actually agreed. Putting a company's logo on our website is a public statement about their business.

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9. Changing wording and photos

Any wording on any page

Page wording in the side list. Then pick the page: Home page, About page, Ty's Story page, and so on.

Inside, every heading and paragraph on that page is its own box, labelled in plain terms — *Hero — main heading*, *Mission — paragraph*. Under each one it tells you what it currently says, so you can find the right box without guessing.

Change the words, press **Save**, and it is live in about a minute.

Ty's sunrise and sunset dates are in here too, under **Ty's Story page** — the boxes labelled *Memorial — line*. The hint under each one shows what it says now, so you can tell them apart. These are the only dates on the site you can change yourself.

If you empty a box, the page keeps what it says now. Clearing a box does not blank the page.

Any photo

Photos live with the thing they belong to. To change the photo on an event, open that event. To change a sponsor's logo, open that sponsor.

Everywhere you can add a photo:

- Upload straight from your phone. **Big photos are shrunk automatically** — you never need to resize anything first.
- **Every photo needs "Describe this photo" filled in** or it will not appear. One short sentence saying what is in it.

Your own photo

Go to **Board & staff**, open your entry, and add **Their photo**. A square photo works best.

That one photo appears in **two** places — beside your name on the About page, and in the leadership list on Where Your Money Goes. You only upload it once and both pages update together.

Until you add one, both pages show your initials in a blue circle. That is deliberate, it looks intentional, and there is no rush.

Photos of children

Only photographs of real young people in our programs, and only where we have a signed media release. Never a stock photo. If there is no photo available, leave it empty — every part of this website is built to look right without one.

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10. Hiding something

Every single thing on this website has a switch called "Show this on the website". Turn it OFF and save. It disappears from the live site immediately and keeps everything you typed.

Use this for:

- an event that got cancelled
- a sponsor whose sponsorship ended
- a story someone asked you to take down
- anything you are part-way through writing

Turning it off is always the right first move. It is instant, it is reversible, and nothing is lost. Deleting is permanent — only delete when you are certain you will never want it back.

If someone asks you to take their story or photo down, turn it off straight away and work out the details afterwards. You do not need to ask anybody's permission to do that.

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11. If something looks broken

Work down this list. Most things stop at step 1 or 2.

1. Wait two minutes and refresh. Saving takes about a minute to reach the live site. Refresh the page: on a phone, pull down from the top.

2. Check the switch. Nine times in ten, "it didn't appear" means **Show this on the website** is still off. Open the entry and look at the top.

3. A photo is missing. Open the entry and check **Describe this photo** has something in it. An empty description means the photo is hidden on purpose.

4. A story about a child is missing. Check the consent switches in section 6. Both must be on. This is the website protecting that child, working exactly as intended.

5. A number is not showing. The number box probably has a comma, a dollar sign, or a `+` in it. Digits only — the symbols go in the separate boxes.

6. The editor shows a blank page. Close the tab completely and open `tysfuturestars.org/admin` again. The website itself is unaffected, and nothing you saved before is lost.

7. It says you do not have access. Check your email for the GitHub invitation and click Accept.

If none of that works

The website is almost certainly fine. Problems with the editor do not take the website down — they are separate things.

Text Grey with:

- what you were trying to change
- what you expected to happen
- what happened instead
- a screenshot if you can

Then stop. **Do not keep pressing Save to see if it fixes itself** — that makes it harder to work out what went wrong.

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12. What not to touch

You genuinely cannot break the site through the editor. These are the few places where a change has consequences you would not expect.

Do not change a "Short name for this entry" or "Web address name"

Once something has been published, that name is part of the link people have shared, bookmarked, or put in a newsletter. Changing it breaks every one of those links. Set it once; after that, leave it.

Do not edit the Privacy Policy or Terms of Use

They are not in the editor, on purpose. They are legal text, and changing a word can change what the foundation has committed to. Email Grey.

Do not invent a number

Not an estimate, not a round-up, not "about". Every figure on this site is one we can evidence. If you do not have the real number, leave it empty — the website is built to look right without it.

Do not write a quote for someone

Testimonials and story quotes must be words the person actually said, with their permission to publish them. A made-up quote attributed to a parent is the single worst thing that could go on this site.

Do not publish a sponsor logo before the partnership is agreed

It is a public claim about someone else's business.

Do not put a home address anywhere

Not in an event address, not in the mailing address. A PO box is fine. A public page with a home address on it is a safety problem.

Do not use a phone number you have not dialled

Especially on the Resources page. Someone in trouble will call it.

A one-minute summary

You want to	Go to
Add an event	**Events** → +
Write news	**Updates** → +
Share a young person's story	**Success stories** → + (read section 6 first)
Change a number	**Impact numbers**
Add a sponsor	**Sponsors** → +
Change words on a page	**Page wording** → pick the page
Change a photo	Open the thing the photo belongs to
Hide anything	Open it → **Show this on the website** OFF → Save

Every entry has a Show-this switch. Every photo needs a description. Every number needs to be real. Saving publishes.

That is the whole system.